

UTT Chapter 08 Test

MULTIPLE CHOICE [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Choose the correct answer from the choices below.

1. **Which prominent atheist had a big influence on the American educational system?**
 - a. Bertrand Russell
 - b. Julian Huxley
 - c. Isaac Asimov
 - d. John Dewey [8.2]
 - e. Paul Kurtz
2. **What is the contemporary form of atheism that not only *denies* the existence of God but also vehemently criticizes and condemns religion?**
 - a. Pantheism
 - b. Polytheism
 - c. New atheism [8.2]
 - d. Agnosticism
 - e. Deism
3. **Marx saw God as an enemy of what?**
 - a. Science
 - b. Materialism
 - c. Socialism
 - d. Communism
 - e. All of the above [8.3]
4. **Which philosopher promoted the idea that God is merely a projection of humanity's own making?**
 - a. Thomas Aquinas
 - b. Blaise Pascal
 - c. Ludwig Feuerbach [8.3]
 - d. John Duns Scotus
 - e. A and B only
5. **Which of the following worldviews hold to atheism?**
 - a. Secularism
 - b. Marxism
 - c. New Spirituality
 - d. All of the above
 - e. A and B only [8.4]

6. According to Postmodernism, religion is what?

- a. A social construction
- b. A metanarrative
- c. True for everyone
- d. All of the above
- e. A and B only [8.4]

7. According to New Spirituality, human beings are ultimately what?

- a. Physical brains
- b. Physical bodies
- c. Evolved animals
- d. Energy fields [8.5]
- e. A and B only

8. What does the word “holy” mean?

- a. Sacred
- b. Set apart
- c. Consecrated
- d. All of the above [8.9c]
- e. None of the above

TRUE OR FALSE [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, alter it to make it true.

9. To be secular means to admit to nothing higher than man.

True [8.2]

10. For Marx, the war against capitalism was also a war against religion.

True [8.3]

11. Most Postmodernists can tolerate religion as long as it is kept public.

False: private [8.4]

12. New Spiritualists believe pantheism has a scientific basis.

True [8.5]

13. According to New Spirituality, God is a person.

False: is not [8.5]

14. According to New Spirituality, there is no difference between creation and the creator.

True [8.5]

15. The goal of reincarnation is to be separated from consciousness.

False: united with [8.5]

16. Islam views the deity of Christ as a heretical belief.

True [8.6]

17. Muslims hold the Bible to be the true and final revelation of God.

False: the Quran [8.6]

18. Because they believe God created it, Christians expect to find chaos in nature.

False: order [8.8]

19. According to Christianity, the God of love is not the God of wrath.

False: is also [8.9b]

FILL-IN-THE-BLANK [Each question is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

20. _____ Theism [8.1] _____ is the belief in the existence of a God or gods.

21. _____ Liberation theology [8.3] _____ is the political movement that interprets the teachings of Jesus Christ as a call to liberate the poor.

22. Many New Spiritualists believe that after death a person's spirit will be re-embodied through _____ reincarnation [8.5] _____.

23. Muslims view the Christian doctrine of the _____ Trinity [8.6] _____ as heretical.

24. The essential creed of Islam (i.e. the *shadada*) states, "There is no God but Allah and _____ Muhammad [8.6] _____ is his prophet."

25. _____ Polytheism [8.6] _____ is the belief in a multitude of deities.

26. The physical law that leads scientists to believe that the universe had a beginning is the _____ second law of thermodynamics [8.8a] _____.
27. _____ Spontaneous generation [8.8b] _____ is the belief that non-living matter produced living matter through purely natural processes.
28. _____ Panspermia [8.8b] _____ is the belief that life arrived on earth from outer space.
29. _____ Genetic information theory [8.8c] _____ states that complexity and information within DNA molecules reveal evidence for design.
30. The _____ anthropic principle [8.8d] _____ states that the universe was designed for human beings.
31. According to _____ Isaiah 44:6 [8.9] _____, there is no god but God.

SHORT ANSWER [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one sentence.

32. Define theology.

Theology is the study of God. [8.1]

33. Define atheism.

Atheism is the belief that God does not exist. [8.1]

34. Define pantheism.

Pantheism is the belief that everything in the universe is divine. [8.1]

35. Define theological suspicion.

Theological suspicion is a general distrust toward any religion claiming to know absolute truth about reality. [8.4]

36. Define monotheism.

Monotheism is the belief in the existence of one God. [8.6]

37. Define Trinitarian monotheism.

Trinitarian monotheism is the belief in one God recognized as three separate and distinct persons: Father, Son, and Spirit. [8.6]

ESSAY [Each question is worth 4 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

38. What is wrong with Postmodernism's claim that truth cannot be objectively known?

The idea that truth cannot be known is a logical contradiction. On the one hand, Postmodernism is claiming that truth is unknowable. On the other hand, it is claiming that this idea is true, and it assumes that it can be known. The position is inherent nonsense. It attempts to affirm one proposition while simultaneously denying it. [8.4]

39. Define religious pluralism. What is the difference between descriptive pluralism and prescriptive pluralism?

Religious pluralism is merely the acknowledgment that we live in a world with a vast array of religions all making competing truth claims. Descriptive pluralism recognizes this fact and concludes that competing religions should be tolerant of one another, while prescriptive pluralism contends that we should be tolerant of other religions because no single religion can be universally true for everyone. The former recognizes that truth exists; the latter assumes that no one has access to objective truth. [8.4]